Theme 4: Travel and Transport

Congestion – A Growing Issue (Present perfect & continuous)

Lesson 4-2
Book pages 52-53

💡 **Big idea:** Miss Smith writes to the City Council because she is late for work every day due to **traffic congestion**. Grammar: **present perfect** (have + past participle) and **present perfect continuous** (have been + -ing).

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read a letter of complaint about traffic
- Use the present perfect for experiences and recent actions
- Use the present perfect continuous for continuing actions
- Choose the correct form in context

📖 Key words

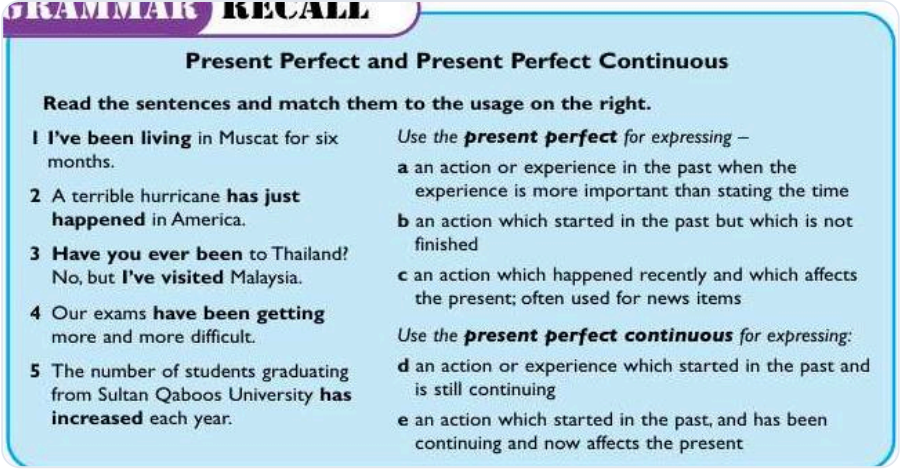
congestion ازدحام مروري	**traffic jam** اختناق مروري	**council** مجلس بلدي	**exhausted** منهك
irritated منزعج	**frustrated** محبط	**stressed** متوتر	**campaign** حملة

Present perfect

- have/has + past participle
- an action/experience where the time is not important: Have you ever been to Thailand?
- an action that started in the past and is not finished
- a recent action that affects the present (news): A terrible hurricane has just happened.

Present perfect continuous

- have/has been + verb-ing
- an action that started in the past and is still continuing: I've been living in Muscat for six months.
- a recent continuing action that affects the present: Your eyes are red. Have you been crying?



GRAMMAR RECALL

Present Perfect and Present Perfect Continuous

Read the sentences and match them to the usage on the right.

1 **I've been living** in Muscat for six months.

2 A terrible hurricane **has just happened** in America.

3 **Have you ever been** to Thailand? No, but **I've visited** Malaysia.

4 Our exams **have been getting** more and more difficult.

5 The number of students graduating from Sultan Qaboos University **has increased** each year.

Use the ***present perfect*** *for expressing –*

a an action or experience in the past when the experience is more important than stating the time

b an action which started in the past but which is not finished

c an action which happened recently and which affects the present; often used for news items

Use the ***present perfect continuous*** *for expressing:*

d an action or experience which started in the past and is still continuing

e an action which started in the past, and has been continuing and now affects the present

Grammar Recall: present perfect and present perfect continuous (p.53)

✏️ Examples

Choose: I'm so tired. I've (studied / been studying) all evening.

Answer: been studying

Choose: Here's a newsflash! Two prisoners have (escaped / been escaping).

Answer: escaped

⭐ Remember

- Use the continuous form to focus on the activity and how long
- use the simple form for the result or completed action.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ I am living in Muscat since 2020.
  ✓ I have been living in Muscat since 2020.

🧩 **Activity:** Plan a party with a partner and make dialogues: Have you written the invitations? No, I've been writing them all morning.

✅ Check yourself

1. Form of the present perfect continuous?
2. Why is Miss Smith unhappy?
3. Complete: I've ___ (catch) a fish!
4. Complete: I've been ___ (fish) all morning.

Answers: (1) have/has been + -ing ، (2) she is late for work every day because of traffic ، (3) caught ، (4) fishing